The emergency summary that travels with the patient

MediChain gives every patient a health ID they carry as a QR code or NFC card. A responder reads the essentials in seconds; the care team works from one record; and the patient sees every access to it.

Why now

Missing records delay care: in a survey of 40 Limpopo hospitals, patients waited longer and some were "treated without medical history" [1]. Courts have found that "numerous South African public health facilities fail to meet their record-keeping obligations" [2]. The national digital-health strategy asks for a person-centred record and a common patient identifier [3].

What is different

- **Seconds, not phone calls:** QR, NFC or card number, on an approved device.
- **Visible to the patient:** every read, emergency included, in their access history.
- **Provable:** access records are signed and stored write-once.
- **Patient-held consent:** access is granted and withdrawn by the patient.

Traction

Live
on AWS in Cape Town since October 2026

7
roles on one record, 116 screens

1,045
server tests, all passing

2nd
place, Rust Africa Hackathon 2026

Business

A per-facility subscription for private clinics, hospital groups and EMS operators; free for patients. One server in Cape Town runs the whole product today for under USD 60 a month.

The ask

One clinic, hospital or EMS partner for a supervised pilot of the emergency summary and handover, and introductions to health-technology funders.

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Sources

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3. National Department of Health (2019). *National Digital Health Strategy for South Africa 2019–2024*. https://knowledgehub.health.gov.za/system/files/elibdownloads/2023-04/national-digital-strategy-for-south-africa-2019-2024-b.pdf